INDICATOR DASHBOARD · DIGITAL FINANCE · SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

In Ethiopia's sample, accounts are common. Using them digitally is not.

Nine indicators of access and digital use for 35 countries, from the World Bank's 2025 Global Findex survey. Ethiopia is below the 35-country average on account ownership, and near the bottom on almost every measure of digital use. Ethiopia's figures cover the areas surveyed, which excluded Amhara, Tigray, Somali and Harari (about 30% of the population).

Analysis and design: Dawit Sileshi

Data: Global Findex 2025 microdata (fielded 2024) · about 1,000 adults per country, weighted

QUESTION
Where does Ethiopia stand on access to and use of digital finance, compared with other African countries?

AUDIENCE
Analysts and partners who need a quick comparison before a deeper study.

DECISION IT INFORMS
Which gap to investigate first: getting people accounts, or getting account holders to use them.

▼ **Data facts: source, coverage and checks**

Source	World Bank Global Findex 2025, individual microdata (CSV release)
Fieldwork	2024; dates vary by country
Population	Adults 15+ in 35 Sub-Saharan countries surveyed. Some samples exclude areas; Ethiopia's excludes Amhara, Tigray, Somali and Harari.
Sample	About 1,000 adults per country, 35,093 in total
Denominators	Set per indicator; see the indicator dictionary below. "Account but no digital payment" uses account holders only.
Missing data	"Don't know" and "refused" answers excluded from the base of phone and smartphone indicators. Mauritania was not asked about mobile money and is left out of that indicator.
Checks	Ethiopia matches all three published values (accounts 48.8%, mobile money 9.5%, digital payments 20.7%). The same code produces every country.
Why interactive	One survey round, so this is for comparing countries, not tracking change. Every view also exists as a table.

58%

of account holders in Ethiopia's sample made or received no digital payment in a year. The highest point estimate of 35 countries.

13%

is the same figure across the 35 countries surveyed, weighted by each country's adult population.

9.5%

of adults in Ethiopia's sample have a mobile money account. Only Niger's point estimate is lower among the 34 countries asked.

Ethiopia scorecard

Ethiopia against the 35-country average. Rank orders point estimates, 1 = best; countries a few points apart may not truly differ.

● Ethiopia | 35-country average

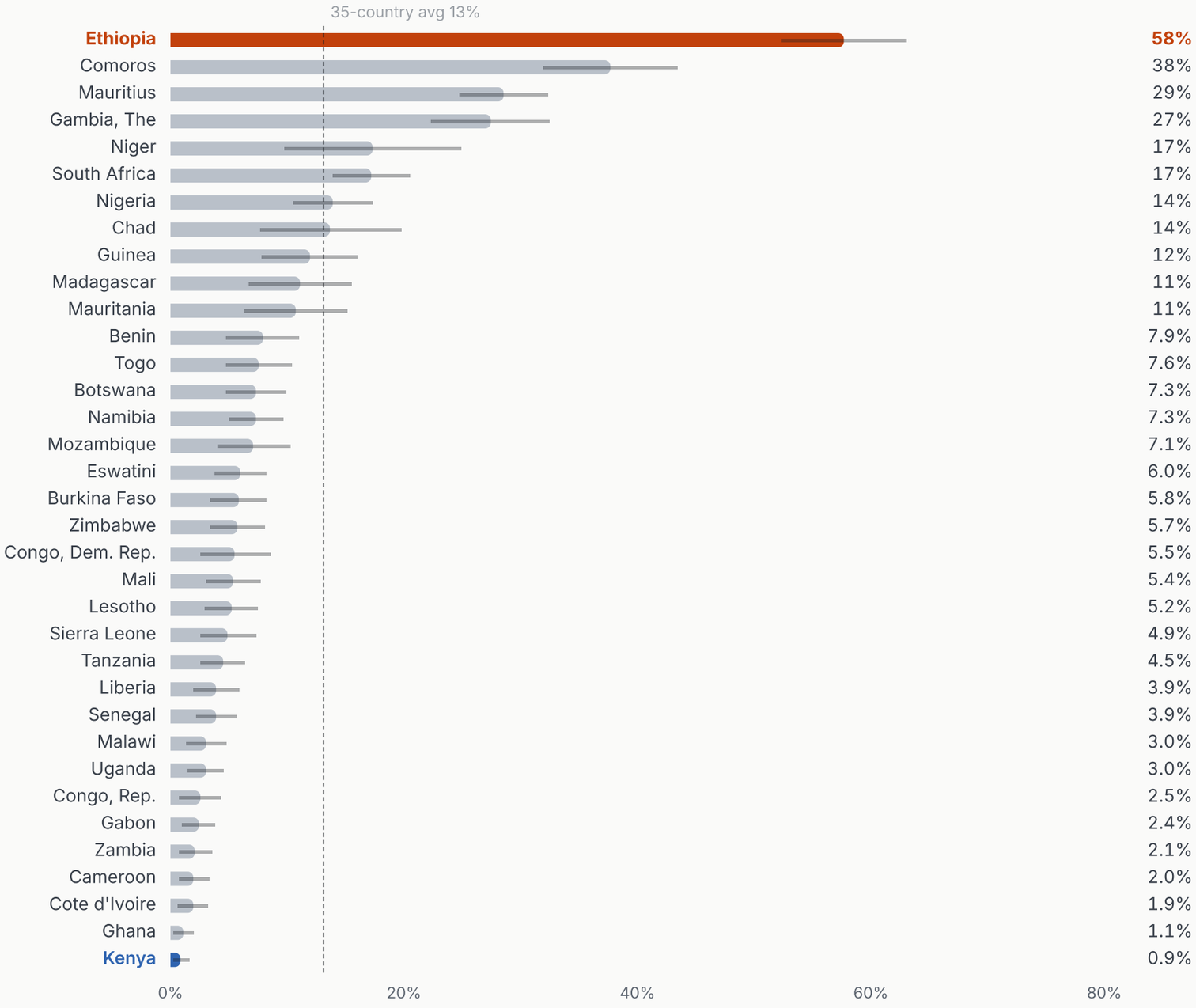
INDICATOR	ETHIOPIA	REGION	RANK	0 – 100%
Account but no digital payment Lower is better	57.7%	13.1%	35 / 35	
Has an account Higher is better	48.8%	58.2%	26 / 35	
Has a mobile money account Higher is better	9.5%	40.2%	33 / 34	
Made or received a digital payment Higher is better	20.7%	50.6%	33 / 35	
Paid a merchant digitally Higher is better	5.9%	19.5%	29 / 35	
Owns a mobile phone Higher is better	58.1%	74.7%	31 / 35	
Owns a smartphone Higher is better	16.3%	33.0%	31 / 35	
Used the internet Higher is better	13.8%	36.3%	33 / 35	
Owns a phone, no account Lower is better	19.8%	21.5%	11 / 35	

Compare all 35 countries

Pick an indicator. Hover a bar for the value and its 95% margin. The dashed line is the 35-country average.

Ethiopia Kenya Other countries 35-country average

Account but no digital payment. Has an account but made or received no digital payment in the past 12 months. Ethiopia: **57.7%**, rank 35 of 35 by point estimate. Kenya: 0.9%. 35-country average: 13.1%.



Indicator dictionary

How each figure is built. Variable names are from the Findex 2025 microdata file. All shares use the survey weight.

INDICATOR	DEFINITION	RULE	BASE	BETTER IS
Account but no digital payment	Has an account but made or received no digital payment in the past 12 months.	`anydigpayment = 0`	Account holders only	lower
Has an account	Account at a bank or similar financial institution, or a mobile money account.	`account = 1`	All adults 15+	higher
Has a mobile money account	Personally uses a mobile money service to send, receive or store money.	`account_mob = 1`	All adults 15+ (not asked in Mauritania)	higher
Made or received a digital payment	Any digital payment in the past 12 months: wages, transfers, bills, purchases, remittances.	`anydigpayment = 1`	All adults 15+	higher
Paid a merchant digitally	Used a card, phone or the internet to pay in a shop or online.	`merchantpay_dig = 1`	All adults 15+	higher
Owns a mobile phone	Has a mobile phone used for personal calls.	`con1 = 1`	Adults who answered yes or no	higher
Owns a smartphone	Owns a phone, and the main phone is a smartphone.	`con1 = 1 and con9 = 1`	Adults who answered both questions	higher
Used the internet	Used the internet in the past three months.	`internet_use = 1`	All adults 15+	higher
Owns a phone, no account	Has a mobile phone but no account of any kind.	`con1 = 1 and account = 0`	Adults who answered the phone question	lower

Method and limits

Validation. Ethiopia's figures match the published Findex 2025 values: account ownership 48.8%, mobile money 9.5%, digital payments 20.7%. The same code produces every country.

Country figures use each country's survey weight. **The 35-country average** rescales each country's weights to its adult population, so large countries count more. It covers only the 35 Sub-Saharan countries in the survey, not the whole region.

Margins are approximate 95% intervals from the effective sample size of the weights. Clustering isn't in the public file, so true margins are wider. Countries a few points apart are often not different.

Limits. One survey round, about 1,000 adults per country, so the picker is for exploring the 35 countries, not for tracking change over time. Some country samples exclude areas; Ethiopia's excludes Amhara, Tigray, Somali and Harari (about 30% of the population). Mauritania was not asked about mobile money. These are shares of adults, not counts of accounts; Ethiopia's 135 million-plus wallets are accounts, many of them unused or held by the same person.

Source: World Bank, Global Findex Database 2025 (doi.org/10.48529/bk9n-8r43). Independent analysis by Dawit Sileshi. Not affiliated with the World Bank or Shega.